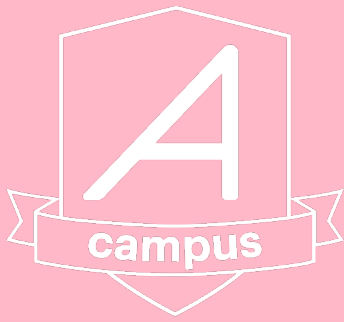




Management Onboarding Training Program

Trainee Guide

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Legend



EXERCISE



ON THE FLOOR



DAILY DEBRIEF



ARDENE CAMPUS

Welcome to the Ardene Management Team!

We are so happy to have you on our management team! By now you have already met your Trainer and toured the store, but as a new member of the management team, we still have plenty to share with you about your role, our customers, stores, product and company.

Of course, being a leader means much more than simply managing tasks and merchandise. As a leader at Ardene, you will be responsible for our most valuable asset: our people!

You will not only be accountable for your own success at work but also for the success and happiness of your team. Being an inspiring leader means finding opportunities to motivate your team to excel, foster growth, encourage collaboration and create a healthy and productive work environment. We've designed this training as an interactive, interesting and stimulating learning experience that will provide you with the foundation needed to excel at Ardene and be the best leader you can be.

The best way to learn is through participation so we welcome questions throughout the program and encourage your active involvement whenever possible. Be curious and get involved!

This guide will lead you through every step of the Ardene Management Training Program and your designated Trainer will be there to help shape and support your learning but ultimately, YOU OWN your development.

LISTEN. ASK QUESTIONS. TAKE NOTES. PRACTICE.

And utilize all the in-store resources to learn more about your role, your store and the company.

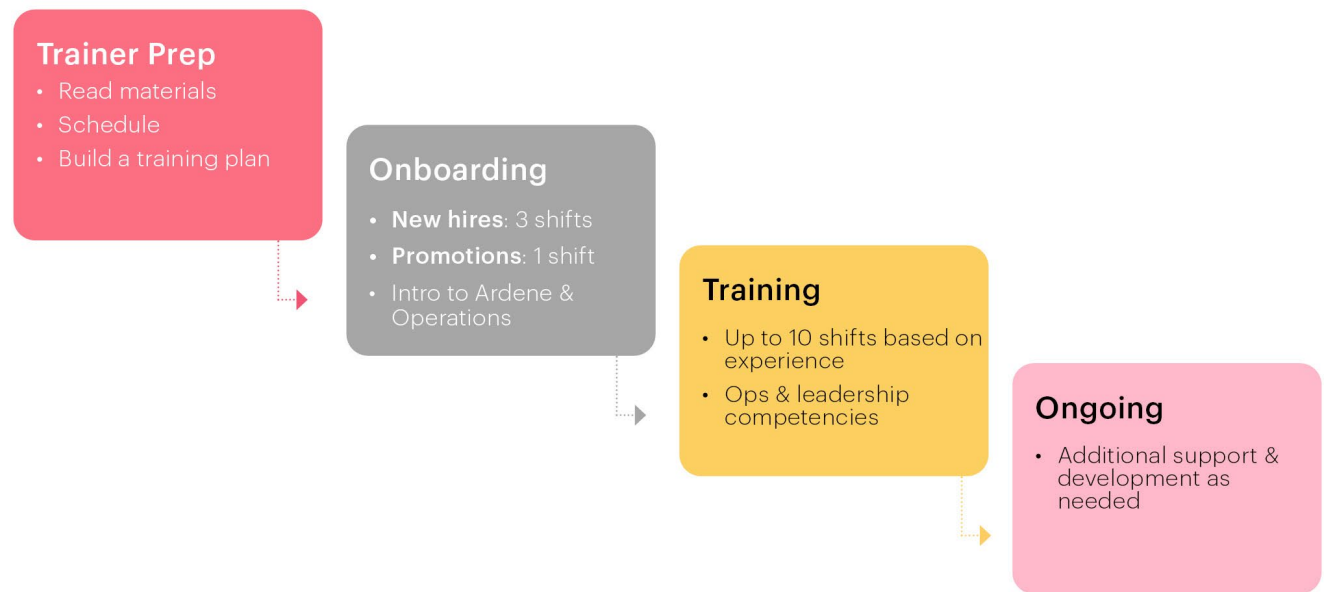
Are you ready to get started? Great, let's begin!

About the Training Program

This training is designed to build confidence and skill by using a mix of coaching, observation, theory, practical exercises and most importantly, lots of hands-on experience.

The Management Training Program is comprised of 13 shifts, however the length can vary for each individual. Depending on your experience and other factors, you may need a little more or a little less time, and that's okay! Our goal is to support you on your learning journey. Remember, your Trainer and your leader are here to answer questions, coach and guide you every step of the way.

Training Roadmap



**Length of the training can be modified to suit the needs of the individual depending on experience and current position.*

Training Expectations

- ☐ Ask questions when you don't understand
- ☐ Take notes and practice as much as possible
- ☐ Complete Ardene Campus lessons as instructed in your Trainee Guide
- ☐ Complete all activities outlined in your Trainee Guide and complete your Trainee Workbook
- ☐ Provide feedback and raise concerns as necessary
- ☐ Start using the tools as you learn about them (Mindful Moment Cards, Recognition Cards, etc.)

Tips for a Successful Training

1. Review your training schedule
 - Start off by verifying your training schedule with your Trainer and review the Training Calendar on **page 3 of your Workbook**.
 - Speak with your Trainer about how to customize your training plan based on experience, skills, knowledge and schedule.
2. Manage your time
 - Even though your shifts are planned out, unexpected situations may arise and you may need to adjust your training schedule. Use the tools provided (calendar, shift checklists, etc.) to make sure you cover all the topics, achieve the learning objectives and get enough practice.
3. Check in with your Trainer
 - Don't skip the Daily Debriefs with your Trainer, this is a good time to ask questions and get the support you need.
 - Your Trainer will sign off on your shift checklists to ensure you have received all the necessary information.

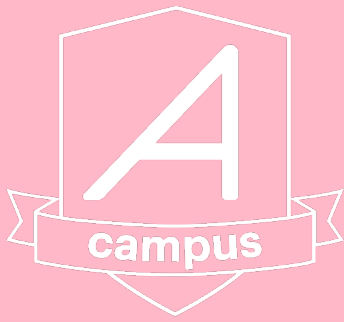
What applies to me?

The chart below is a recommended guide for standard cases. Always review your experience, needs and business factors with your Trainer to build an individualized training plan that is right for you.

	Internal Promotion*			External Hire		
	Store Manager	Assistant Manager	Third Key Holder/ Visual	Store Manager	Assistant Manager	Third Key Holder/ Visual
Onboarding						
3 shifts				X	X	X
Abridged Onboarding (1 shift)	X	X	X			
The Opening Shift						
Opening Procedures			X	X	X	X
Minute Meetings			X	X	X	X
Dayforce, Payroll & Scheduling	X	X		X	X	
Manager on Duty Responsibilities			X			X
The Closing Shift						
APOS for Managers	X	X		X	X	
Loss Prevention for Managers	X	X	X	X	X	X
Calculating KPI's	X	X	X	X	X	X
Closing Procedures			X	X	X	X
The Health, Safety & Shipment Shift						
Health & Safety for Managers	X	X	X	X	X	X
Backstore Organization	X	X	X	X	X	X
Receiving and Processing Shipments	X	X	X	X	X	X
The Visual & Merchandising Shift #1						
Visual & Merchandising for Managers #1	X	X	X	X	X	X
The Visual & Merchandising Shift #2						
Visual & Merchandising for Managers #2	X	X	X	X	X	X
The Recruitment Shift						
Recruitment for Managers	X	X		X	X	

	Internal Promotion*			External Hire		
	Store Manager	Assistant Manager	Third Key Holder/ Visual	Store Manager	Assistant Manager	Third Key Holder/ Visual
The Leadership Shift						
Motivation	X	X	X	X	X	X
Conflict Resolution	X	X	X	X	X	X
Change Management & Mindfulness	X	X	X	X	X	X
Mental Health at Work	X	X		X	X	
Employee Performance	X	X		X	X	
The Admin Day Shift						
The Admin Day	X	X		X	X	
The Performance Shift						
Omnichannel	X	X	X	X	X	X
Customer Loyalty	X	X	X	X	X	X
Tools to Drive Performance	X	X	X	X	X	X
KPI's	X	X	X	X	X	X
Objectives	X	X		X	X	
The Recap Shift						
Review	X	X	X	X	X	X

**If you have already completed parts of this training guide from a previous promotion, it is not necessary to repeat them. Speak with your Trainer to identify which areas you should cover.*



Onboarding

To help get you started, this program will begin with some basics. Over the next three shifts, you will learn about the company, our expectations and everything you need to know to become a productive member of the team. You may come with some great management experience, which we value very much. To complement this experience, you will learn about the specifics of Ardene operations and the day-to-day of our Sales Associates. This will allow you to be a knowledgeable and informed leader.

If you have already been part of the Ardene team for some time and are completing this training because of a recent promotion, congratulations! Skip directly to the Abridged Onboarding on **page 17**.

Onboarding Shift 1 (8 hours)

Activity	Suggested Time
- Welcome & store tour - Review Trainee documents, training schedule and expectations	1 hour
- Review job description - Introduction to Ardene Campus: - Tutorial Video - Introduction - Drive for Results - Review and discuss the <i>We Are Ardene</i> framework and how performance is measured	1 hour 30 min
- Review the material on the Backstore Boards - Ardene Campus lessons: - Policies & Guidelines course : All lessons - Social Responsibility course : All lessons	2 hours 30 min
- Introduction to the Associate Onboarding Program - Associate Shift 1	2 hours
Daily Debrief	30 min

*Shift includes a 30-minute break. Confirm your schedule with your Trainer.

After completing this module, you should be able to:

- ☐ Understand your role as a member of the management team at Ardene.
- ☐ Explain the different areas of the store.
- ☐ Understand how your performance will be measured and how to manage accordingly.
- ☐ Explain Ardene's policies, programs and values and how you bring them to life in your store.

Welcome



ON THE FLOOR: STORE TOUR

Your Trainer will start by taking you around the store to show the different departments and zones as well as important safety information.



Psst! You can download the Dayforce app for easy access to your payroll and scheduling information.

Job Description

Let's get you started by reviewing and discussing your job description with your Trainer.



Psst! All job descriptions can be found on Gr8 People.



EXERCISES #1-2

ARDENE CAMPUS

Ardene Campus is the name of our computer-based learning platform. This is where you will find all kinds of important information to support your learning throughout this training and beyond. Ardene Campus will be your guide for product knowledge and new programs during your entire career at Ardene. Your Trainer will give you an introduction and show you how to access the platform.

Complete the following lessons on Ardene Campus:

- Tutorial Video
- Introduction
- Drive for Results

 **Psst!** You can download the Ardene Campus app for easy access to important reference material.

We Are Ardene

We Are Ardene is a framework of values, competencies and leadership abilities established at Ardene. This framework sets the expectations for what we EMBODY and how we ACT and LEAD. It defines who we ARE as an organization and what we expect from our employees. As a leader, your role is critical to the success of your store and the company, and so understanding what is expected of you, what the company's goals are and which behaviours are encouraged is critical to your success. Furthermore, as a leader, your team will look up to you and their behaviour will reflect your own. Remember, be a role model! Use these founding principles to guide your daily interactions with your team and with customers.

EXERCISES #3-5

Policies & Guidelines

As a leader, it is important that you review, understand and adhere to all of our policies and programs. Furthermore, you are an ambassador for the company so it is essential that you can explain them, stay informed of any changes and ensure compliance among the whole team.

ARDENE CAMPUS

Take some time to review all the information posted on both Backstore Boards and complete the following on Ardene Campus:

- Policies & Guidelines course: All lessons
- Social Responsibility course: All lessons

Take note of any questions you have along the way in your Trainee Workbook.

Now that you have read through all the policies on Ardene Campus and the Backstore Board, complete exercise #6 and discuss your answers and any questions you have with your Trainer. Don't worry if you don't remember everything you've just read, it's a lot of information! You will have time later on in your training to review.

EXERCISE #6

Onboarding Program for New Associates

Just like management, Ardene associates are provided with materials to facilitate their learning during their first few days on the job. Each associate is paired with a Mentor and provided a booklet to guide them through their first five shifts. Over your first few shifts, you will focus on the Associate Booklet and complete the Associate Onboarding training as an introduction to the company, the associate role and our operational procedures.

In your new management role, you may be called upon to support the onboarding of new associates. As you complete the Onboarding Program for New Associates, there may be a lot of material you are already familiar with, so we encourage you to also wear the hat of a future Mentor or Manager. More information about your Mentor or Manager role will be provided during the Onboarding Shift 3.

Your Trainer will provide you with a Booklet for New Associates and act as your mentor. Since you've already received your introduction and Store Tour, you can start at Exercise #1 in the booklet and complete Shift 1 for today.

Congratulations, you've completed your first shift at Ardene! Before you leave, take some time to debrief with your Trainer, share your experiences and discuss any questions you still have.



DAILY DEBRIEF

Complete the Daily Debrief in your Trainee Workbook.

Onboarding Shift 1 Checklist

Complete the checklist in your Trainee Workbook by checking all the topics you've covered today. If you missed any, be sure to speak with your Trainer and set a time to review. When you've covered everything, ask your Trainer to sign off at the bottom of the page.

Welcome

- ☐ Introduction to the Management Onboarding Program
- ☐ The role of my Trainer
- ☐ Training schedule and expectations
- ☐ Bag check
- ☐ Dayforce and pay schedule introduction

The Team

- ☐ Introduction to the team
- ☐ Size and structure of the team

Store Tour

- ☐ Store layout and zones
- ☐ Current merchandise
- ☐ Basic overview of visual presentation and placement of merchandise
- ☐ Emergency meeting place
- ☐ Emergency contact numbers

Job Description

- ☐ Job description

Introduction to Ardene Campus

- ☐ Tutorial Video
- ☐ Introduction lesson
- ☐ Drive for Results lesson

We Are Ardene

- ☐ Our Values, Core Competencies & Leadership Abilities

Policies & Guidelines

- ☐ Backstore Boards
- ☐ Policies & Guidelines course on Ardene Campus
- ☐ Social Responsibility course on Ardene Campus

Onboarding Program for New Associates

- ☐ Associate Onboarding Program Shift 1

Onboarding Shift 2 (8 hours)

Today you will continue your onboarding by completing Shifts 2 & 3 from the New Associate Onboarding.

Note: There is no Daily Debrief or Shift Checklist provided for the Onboarding Shift 2. Use the Mentor Meetings and checklists from Shifts 2 and 3 in the New Associate Booklet to assess your learnings.

Activity	Suggested Time
Associate Training Shift 2 Note: Reduce On the Floor: Department time by 30 min for your break	3 hours 30 min
Associate Training Shift 3	4 hours

**Shift includes a 30-minute break. Confirm your schedule with your Trainer.*

Onboarding Shift 3 (8 hours)

Continue your onboarding by completing Shifts 4 & 5 from the Onboarding Program for New Associates and reviewing the program tools.

Activity	Suggested Time
Associate Training Shift 4	4 hours
Associate Training Shift 5 Note: Do not complete the 1.5 hours of optional training	2 hours 15 min
- Ardene Campus lesson: SM & AM only: - Ardene Campus Onboarding Program - Review the Booklets for Managers & for Mentors - Discuss your role as a leader when onboarding new associates	1 hour
Daily Debrief	15 min

**Shift includes a 30-minute break. Confirm your schedule with your Trainer.*

After completing this module, you should be able to:

- ☐ Understand the associate role
- ☐ Be familiar with the Ardene Campus Onboarding Program for New Associates
- ☐ Understand your role when onboarding new hires and the impact you have on their performance

Ardene Campus Onboarding Program

Now that you have completed the Onboarding Program for New Associates, let's take a look at the program as a whole and see how you will be responsible for onboarding new hires.

TKH: As a leader on your team, you may be asked to be a Mentor for new hires in the future. Review the Mentor Booklet, then complete exercise #7.

SM & AM only: As a Store Manager or Assistant Manager, you will oversee the training of new associates and will be responsible for choosing mentors. Complete the following lesson on Ardene Campus and read through the Manager and Mentor Booklets. Then complete exercise #7 before discussing with your Trainer.

ARDENE CAMPUS

SM & AM only: Complete the following lesson on Ardene Campus.

- Ardene Campus Onboarding Program

EXERCISE #7

DAILY DEBRIEF

Complete the Daily Debrief in your Trainee Workbook.

Onboarding Shift 3 Checklist

Complete the checklist in your Trainee Workbook by checking all the topics you've covered today. If you missed any, be sure to speak with your Trainer and set a time to review. When you've covered everything, ask your Trainer to sign off at the bottom of the page.

Ardene Campus Onboarding Program

- ☐ Associate Onboarding Program Shifts 4 & 5
 - How associates learn about new products and collections
 - How the associate role can contribute to visual standards in store
- ☐ How onboarding can impact new associates and their performance
- ☐ Your role as a leader when onboarding new associates
 - Booklets for Managers & for Mentors

SM & AM only:

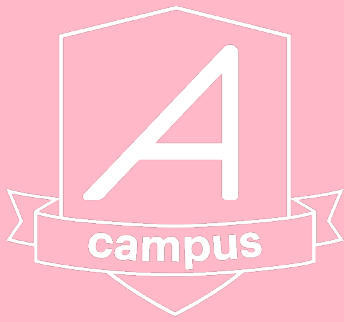
- Onboarding Program lesson on Ardene Campus

Abridged Onboarding for Internal Promotions

Since you've already been with Ardene for some time and are most likely already familiar with the content from the Ardene Campus Onboarding Program for New Associates, complete only the following topics and all exercises from #1-7 on day 1 of your new promotion.

Activity	Suggested Time	See Page(s)
Introduction to the Management Training, Trainee Guide and training schedule	30 min	3-4
- Review job description - Ardene Campus lessons: - Introduction - Drive for Results - Review and discuss the <i>We Are Ardene</i> framework and how performance is measured	1 hour 30 min	9-10
- Review the material on the Backstore Boards - Ardene Campus lessons: - Policies & Guidelines course : All lessons - Social Responsibility course : All lessons	2 hours	10
- Ardene Campus lesson: SM & AM only: - Ardene Campus Onboarding Program - Review the Booklets for Managers & for Mentors - Discuss your role as a leader when onboarding new associates	2 hours	15
Practice or review any topic from the Associate Onboarding Program as needed	1 hour	N/A
- Daily Debriefs from Onboarding Shifts 1 & 3 - Checklists from Onboarding Shifts 1 & 3	30 min	Workbook p.8-10 p.12-14

*Shift includes a 30-minute break. Confirm your schedule with your Trainer.



Training

Congratulations! You've completed the Onboarding portion of your Management training. Now that you are more familiar with Ardene, our culture and the way we work, it's time to get into the day to day of a manager and the responsibilities that come with the title.

Note that the following shifts can be completed in any order (aside from the Recap shift, which has to be completed last) and some of the information may not be relevant to your role. Refer back to your training calendar for your individualized plan.

If adjustments are needed along the way, don't hesitate to speak with your Trainer to modify your plan.

ARDENE

The Opening Shift (8 hours)

Activity	Suggested Time
- Review Opening procedures - Assist with an opening and complete all relevant tasks	2 hours
Prepare for and present a Minute Meeting	30 min
- Ardene Campus lessons: AM & SM only: - Dayforce Schedule Optimization - Timesheet & Missing Punches - Dayforce Forms Training Guide Part 1 SM only: - Dayforce Opening Hours - Dayforce Procedures for Managers - Dayforce Forms Training Guide Part 2 - Review Dayforce and assist with building a schedule	2 hours 30 min
- Review MOD responsibilities - Practice being MOD	2 hours
Daily Debrief	30 min

**Shift includes a 30-minute break. Confirm your schedule with your Trainer.*

After completing this module, you should be able to:

- ☐ Open the store and set your team up for a successful day
- ☐ Understand the role and responsibilities of a Manager on Duty (MOD)
- ☐ Describe how the MOD impacts results
- ☐ Coach and provide guidance on the customer service model
- ☐ Facilitate an inspiring, informed and goal-focused Minute Meeting
- ☐ Describe your role and responsibilities when scheduling and managing payroll
- ☐ Appropriately distribute workforce to better support store needs and achieve your wage cost (WC) objectives

Opening Procedures

Before beginning the opening with your Trainer, take some time to review the following best practices and tools to efficiently prepare for the day ahead. When you're ready, assist your Trainer and, together, complete all tasks on the Opening Checklist.

Remember, a good opening is essential to a well-managed store. It will help set yourself and your team up for success by facilitating great customer service, encouraging sales and providing a clean and safe environment.



Tools Needed to Open the Store:

- ☐ Planner
- ☐ Schedule and daily breaks
- ☐ Minute Meeting notes
- ☐ Opening Checklist

Best Practices:

During an opening, you are your team's main source of information, direction and feedback. Communication and delegation are key to a quick and efficient opening. Follow the tips below to ensure you and your team are set up for success:

- ☐ Stay focused on important issues
- ☐ Make confident and well-informed decisions
- ☐ Give clear instructions to your team to ensure they understand their roles and responsibilities
- ☐ Find opportunities to motivate employees to reach daily sales targets by setting SMART* goals
- ☐ Respond immediately to challenges
- ☐ Lead by example

More information about SMART goals can be found in the Leadership Shift and in the lesson "Motivating Your Team" on Ardene Campus (AM & SM only**).*

Now use the Opening Checklist available in store to help your Trainer complete the opening. When you are done, complete exercises #8-9 in your Trainee Workbook.



EXERCISES #8-9

Minute Meetings

The Minute Meeting is a time to celebrate team wins or individual accomplishments, provide appreciation and words of encouragement, set goals and clarify expectations for the shift ahead. It's meant to be brief and impactful, and is not the right time to resolve complex issues or conflicts. A motivating Minute Meeting can elevate the team's experience, knowledge and engagement while encouraging participation and confidence.

Now that you have witnessed your Trainer lead a Minute Meeting, review best practices and complete exercise #10. When you are done, you will be able to present the Minute Meeting at the start of the next shift change.

Remember, keep it positive to set the tone for a productive day!

Suggested Topics:

- Recent results (i.e. performance, sales or KPI's) and achievements
- Daily objectives, desired sales goals or desired customer service
- Pertinent and timely information (i.e. price changes, new merchandise, customer service updates, promotions or new programs)
- Appreciation for the team's hard work and support
- Mindful Moment*

**More information about Mindful Moments can be found in the Leadership Shift and in the lesson "Mindful Moments" on Ardene Campus (AM & SM only).*

Best Practices:

- ☐ Keep it short and simple
- ☐ Only share relevant information
- ☐ Make it positive and motivational
- ☐ Include all team members currently working
- ☐ Complete one at the beginning of each shift



EXERCISE #10

Dayforce, Payroll & Scheduling

Understanding your peak hours will help you make better scheduling decisions and allow you to put your most efficient employees at the busiest times. However, remember that it is also important to ensure all employees keep learning and receive the necessary exposure to increase their efficiency in all tasks. Cross-training is essential in building a proactive and agile team that can respond to the changing needs of the business.

Another important factor in building a schedule is availability. Taking the time to regularly review availabilities, blackout periods and upcoming staffing needs with your employees will help you foresee any gaps and make scheduling a breeze. Also ensure all employees update their availabilities in Dayforce. This will help centralize all communications regarding changes in availabilities and will greatly simplify your scheduling process.

Main responsibilities:

- ☐ Create the store schedule in Dayforce at least 2 weeks in advance
- ☐ Process employment changes in Dayforce
- ☐ Make changes to the existing schedule as needed
- ☐ Audit daily punches and make corrections if needed



Tools to help you build schedules that meet payroll and sales targets*:

- ☐ Planner
- ☐ Dayforce
- ☐ Comp sales and targets
- ☐ Sales by hour analysis
- ☐ Wage cost (WC %) objectives

**Refer to the KPI formula sheet in the Drive for Results lesson if needed.*

ARdene CAMPUS

Complete the following lessons on Ardene Campus to learn more about scheduling and payroll:

AM & SM only:

- Dayforce Schedule Optimization
- Timesheet & Missing Punches
- Dayforce Forms Training Guide Part 1

SM only:

- Dayforce Opening Hours
- Dayforce Procedures for Managers
- Dayforce Forms Training Guide Part 2

Then, meet with your Trainer and have them review the Payroll and Scheduling responsibilities with you before completing exercise #11.

EXERCISE #11

Manager on Duty (MOD)

As a member of the management team, there are times when you will be the only manager at the store. As MOD, Ardene expects you to manage the store according to our company standards and lead your team with respect and compassion. You are responsible for sales and operational tasks as well as coaching the team and guiding them on any challenges that may occur.

Discuss with your Trainer to learn more about their experience and review the MOD responsibilities.

EXERCISES #12-14

ON THE FLOOR: MOD PRACTICE

Spend the rest of the day acting as MOD. Don't forget to check in with your Trainer at the end of the day.

DAILY DEBRIEF

Complete the Daily Debrief in your Trainee Workbook.

The Opening Shift Checklist

Complete the checklist in your Trainee Workbook by checking all the topics you've covered today. If you missed any, be sure to speak with your Trainer and set a time to review. When you've covered everything, ask your Trainer to sign off at the bottom of the page.

Opening Procedures

- ☐ How to open the store
- ☐ Store walkthrough during opening
- ☐ Reviewing messages and Webportal communications to stay up-to-date on price changes, promos and new merchandise

Minute Meetings

- ☐ Minute Meeting topics and best practices
- ☐ Keeping the team motivated and engaged
- ☐ Recognizing achievements

Dayforce, Payroll & Scheduling

- ☐ How scheduling can impact performance and results in your store
- ☐ Preparing a weekly schedule
- ☐ Ardene Campus lessons:

AM & SM only:

- Timesheet & Missing Punches
- Dayforce Schedule Optimization
- Dayforce Forms Training Guide Part 1

SM only:

- Dayforce Opening Hours
- Dayforce Procedures for Managers
- Dayforce Forms Training Guide Part 2

Manager on Duty (MOD)

- ☐ MOD Role and responsibilities
- ☐ Coaching on customer service

The Closing Shift (8 hours)

Activity	Suggested Time
- Ardene Campus lessons: - Returns for Online Purchases - Safe Operating Procedures for Handling Cash and Daily Deposits - Review APOS responsibilities & procedures	1 hour
- Ardene Campus lessons: - Loss Prevention - Loss Prevention Guidelines - Complete the LP training for Managers - Practice	2 hours 30 min
Review KPI's and how to calculate them	1 hour 30 min
- Review Closing procedures - Assist with a close and complete all relevant tasks	2 hours 30 min
Daily Debrief with your Trainer	N/A

**Shift includes a 30-minute break. Confirm your schedule with your Trainer.*

After completing this module, you should be able to:

- ☐ Understand APOS procedures for managers and be able to assist your team with issues
- ☐ Know what you can do to prevent loss in your store
- ☐ Explain the different KPI's used to measure performance and calculate them
- ☐ Describe what reports are available and learn how to use them to track KPI's
- ☐ Close the store and prepare for the following day

APOS for Managers



Complete the following lessons on Ardene Campus to learn more about the APOS.

- Returns for Online Purchases
- Safe Operating Procedures for Handling Cash and Daily Deposits

Then, meet with your Trainer and have them review additional APOS manager responsibilities. Take note of any important information in your Workbook.

Loss Prevention for Managers

ARDENE CAMPUS

Review the following on Ardene Campus to learn more about your LP responsibilities as a manager.

- Loss Prevention
- Loss Prevention Guidelines

EXERCISE #15

ON THE FLOOR: MOD PRACTICE – LOSS PREVENTION

Now that you understand how to prevent loss in your store, spend the next hour as MOD. Find opportunities to coach the team on customer service and the impact it can have on preventing theft.

KPI's and How to Calculate Them

KPI's, or Key Performance Indicators, are how we measure performance and drive results. As a leader, you will need to understand their meaning and how to use them. It is important to analyse them daily and use them to set goals during the Minute Meeting.

Take some time to review the list of KPI's previously introduced in the Drive for Results lesson on Ardene Campus. This chart shows their common acronyms, formulas and where to find the relevant numbers. Review and make sure you know this information well.

You will learn more about using KPI's to drive store results in the Performance Shift.

EXERCISE #16

Closing Procedures

Tonight, you will complete a close with your Trainer. Take some time to review the following best practices and tools to efficiently prepare the store for the next day and complete exercises #15-16. When you're ready, assist your Trainer and complete all tasks on the Closing Checklist.

Remember, a good close is important to ensure the opening team is set up for success. By ensuring that your store is clean and organized at close, you are also ensuring a quick and efficient opening.



Tools Needed to Close the Store:

- ☐ Planner
- ☐ Schedule and daily breaks
- ☐ Closing Checklist

Best Practices:

During a close, you are your team's main source of information, direction and feedback. Communication and delegation are key to a quick and efficient close. Follow the tips below to ensure you and your team are prepared:

- ☐ Stay focused on important issues
- ☐ Make confident and well-informed decisions
- ☐ Give clear instructions to your team to ensure they understand their roles and responsibilities
- ☐ Respond immediately to challenges
- ☐ Lead by example



EXERCISES #17-18

Afterwards, use the Closing Checklist to help your Trainer complete the close.



DAILY DEBRIEF

Complete the Daily Debrief in your Trainee Workbook.

Note: Since this shift includes a close, it may be difficult to meet your Trainer at the end of the day. If this is the case, simply complete this Daily Debrief and the shift checklist at the start of your next shift.

The Closing Shift Checklist

Complete the checklist in your Trainee Workbook by checking all the topics you've covered today. If you missed any, be sure to speak with your Trainer and set a time to review. When you've covered everything, ask your Trainer to sign off at the bottom of the page.

APOS for Managers

- ☐ Manager responsibilities on the APOS
- ☐ Return for Online Purchases lesson on Ardene Campus

Loss Prevention for Managers

- ☐ Manager responsibilities to prevent theft
- ☐ How to prevent External Theft through customer service
- ☐ How to prevent Internal Theft of merchandise
- ☐ How to inform and train your staff on LP responsibilities
- ☐ Safe Operating Procedures for Handling Cash and Daily Deposits lesson on Ardene Campus

Calculating KPI's

- ☐ KPI formulas and reports available

Closing Procedures

- ☐ How to close the store
- ☐ Expected condition of the store before leaving for the night
- ☐ Delegating and following up
- ☐ Communicating unfinished tasks to the opening team
- ☐ Appreciate and thank the team for their hard work

The Health, Safety & Shipment Shift (8 hours)

Activity	Suggested Time
- Review the Workplace Safety & Security lesson in Policies & Guidelines on Ardene Campus - Ardene Campus lessons: - Customer Incident Procedure SM & AM only: - ID Verification - Work Incident Procedure - Drug & Alcohol Q&A SM & AM, Canada only: - Windley Ely Work Accident Report - Review the H&S Audit - Complete the H&S exercise - Practice	3 hours 30 min
- Review best practices for organizing your backstore - Review the procedures for receiving and processing a shipment - Receive and process a shipment	3 hours 30 min
Daily Debrief with your Trainer	30 min

**Shift includes a 30-minute break. Confirm your schedule with your Trainer.*

After completing this module, you should be able to:

- ☐ Ensure your store is a safe space for yourself, your employees and customers
- ☐ Respond to and report any work accidents
- ☐ Complete a H&S Audit
- ☐ Process incoming and outgoing shipments safely and efficiently
- ☐ Organize your backstore safely and efficiently

Workplace Health & Safety for Managers



ARDENE CAMPUS

Review the policies from the Workplace Safety & Security lesson on Ardene Campus. Take note of any questions you may have for your Trainer in your Trainee Workbook. Then, complete the following on Ardene Campus, if applicable:

- Customer Incident Procedure

SM & AM only:

- ID Verification
- Work Incident Procedure
- Drug and Alcohol Q&A

SM & AM, Canada only:

- Windley Ely Work Accident Report

Next, review the following topics with your Trainer:

- ☐ The H&S Audit guidelines and form
- ☐ Workplace accident forms and the responsibilities of an MOD to report
- ☐ Violence & Harassment Policy (or corresponding document for your location)
- ☐ Reporting maintenance issues



EXERCISES #19-20



ON THE FLOOR: MOD PRACTICE – HEALTH & SAFETY

When you are done, spend the next hour as MOD and pay particular attention to any health and safety hazards. Find opportunities to coach the team on safe work practices.

Organizing Your Backstore

While it's obvious why the front of the store must stay customer-ready at all times, an organized backstore is equally important, as it can make all the difference in your day-to-day operations. Placing signage, commodities and classes methodically can help you keep the store running smoothly and provide the best customer experience at all times. Review best practices with your Trainer before the shipment arrives.

Best Practices:

- ☐ Organize and identify incoming boxes by department and class
- ☐ Keep marketing elements separate from the trash area
- ☐ Ensure the rest of the team is aware of how the backstore is organized
- ☐ Review your Weekly Store Assessment to ensure the backstore is tidy and up to standards
- ☐ Follow health and safety guidelines at all times

Receiving and Processing Shipments

ARDENE CAMPUS

Review the following lesson on Arden Campus and discuss shipping procedures with your Trainer before helping with today's shipment:

- How to Process Shipments

Before your shipment arrives, help your Trainer prepare defect returns or any boxes that need to be transferred out.

Practice the following tasks as you process today's shipment:

- ☐ Completing return requests for outgoing boxes
- ☐ Prepare stickers for outgoing boxes
- ☐ Scanning all incoming and outgoing boxes

DAILY DEBRIEF

Complete the Daily Debrief in your Trainee Workbook.

The Health, Safety & Shipment Shift Checklist

Complete the checklist in your Trainee Workbook by checking all the topics you've covered today. If you missed any, be sure to speak with your Trainer and set a time to review. When you've covered everything, ask your Trainer to sign off at the bottom of the page.

Workplace Health & Safety for Managers

- ☐ A leader's role in creating a safe work environment
- ☐ How to maintain a safe store, free of hazards
- ☐ How to increase health and safety awareness
- ☐ Procedures to report incidents involving customers
- ☐ Procedures to report work accidents
- ☐ Procedures to report maintenance issues
- ☐ Lessons on Ardene Campus:
 - Health & Safety
 - Customer Incident Procedure

SM & AM only:

- ID Verification
- Work Incident Procedure
- Drug & Alcohol Q&A

SM & AM, Canada only:

- Windley Ely Work Accident Report

Backstore Organization

- ☐ Best practices for organizing your backstore

Receiving & Processing Shipments

- ☐ Procedures to receive shipments efficiently
- ☐ Effective placement of newly received stock
- ☐ Lesson How to Process Shipments on Ardene Campus

The Visual & Merchandising Shift #1 (8 hours)

Activity	Suggested Time
- Complete the following on Ardene Campus: - Present in Style course: All lessons - Stay in the Know course: All lessons - Review the Visual & Marketing Binder - Review how to refresh visual displays - Practice	2 hours 30 min
- Review how to integrate new products - Practice	4 hours 30 min
Daily Debrief with your Trainer	30 min

*Shift includes a 30-minute break. Confirm your schedule with your Trainer.

After completing this module, you should be able to:

- ☐ Identify the different types of floor fixtures and hardware
- ☐ Merchandise new product by commodity and by collection
- ☐ Create impactful presentations and refresh visual displays
- ☐ Effectively communicate and delegate merchandising tasks to your team

Visual Merchandising & Marketing Standards for Managers

Maintaining visual standards and ensuring that your store is at its best is a big part of your role at Ardene. An organized and visually appealing store makes it easy and inviting for our customers to shop and find exactly what they are looking for. Although every store is unique, they all share a basic layout. Use your Merchandising Visual Standards Binder to help you adapt visual plans from Head Office to the needs of your store.

ARDENE CAMPUS

Complete any outstanding lessons in the following courses on Ardene Campus:

- Present in Style course : All lessons
- Stay in the Know course : All lessons

EXERCISE #21

Merchandising Visual Standards Binder

The Merchandising Visual Standards Binder specifies the requirements in terms of visual presentation and marketing elements in our stores. Take some time to review the following tabs in the binder:

- General Information
- Tables
- Folding
- T-stands & Grids

Answer exercise #22 in your Trainee Workbook while you read through these sections.



EXERCISES #22-23



ON THE FLOOR: VISUAL PRESENTATION

With the help of your Trainer, pick one section of the store that needs to be refreshed and apply your learnings about visual presentation, referring to our standards as needed. Once completed, review your work with your Trainer and answer the questions in exercise #24 in your Trainee Workbook.



EXERCISE #24

How to Integrate New Products

Review the following tools with your Trainer before completing exercises #25-26.



Tools to help you with the integration of new products:

- ☐ Visual & Merchandising Binder
- ☐ Product breakdown and inventory levels
- ☐ Floor plans
- ☐ Latest visual directives



EXERCISES #25-26



ON THE FLOOR: MOD PRACTICE - COACHING ON VISUAL PRESENTATION

Now spend the next few hours as MOD. Delegate visual tasks as needed and practice coaching the team on refreshing visual presentations.



DAILY DEBRIEF

Complete the Daily Debrief in your Trainee Workbook.

The Visual & Merchandising Shift #1 Checklist

Complete the checklist in your Trainee Workbook by checking all the topics you've covered today. If you missed any, be sure to speak with your Trainer and set a time to review. When you've covered everything, ask your Trainer to sign off at the bottom of the page.

Visual Merchandising & Marketing Standards for Managers

- ☐ How to drive sales with visual merchandising
- ☐ Ardene Visual Standards
- ☐ Present in Style course on Ardene Campus
- ☐ Stay in the Know course on Ardene Campus
- ☐ Coaching your team on routinely refreshing visual displays
- ☐ Different types of floor fixtures and hardware
- ☐ Visual displays on tables

Merchandising Visual Binder

- ☐ How to use the Merchandising Visual Binder
- ☐ Sections of the Binder:
 - General Information
 - Tables
 - Folding
 - T-stands & Grids

How to Integrate New Products

- ☐ Placement of new products by commodity
- ☐ Effectively communicate and delegate merchandising tasks to your team

The Visual & Merchandising Shift #2 (8 hours)

Activity	Suggested Time
- Review Merchandising Visual Binder, Continued - Review a Launch Package, related memos & newsletters	2 hours
- Review price changes - Build a wall	3 hours
Practice	2 hours
Daily Debrief with your Trainer	30 min

**Shift includes a 30-minute break. Confirm your schedule with your Trainer.*

After completing this module, you should be able to:

- ☐ Understand Visual Standards and how to hold your team accountable
- ☐ Execute in-store marketing and promotions
- ☐ Adapt and execute a Launch Package
- ☐ Delegate and follow up with your team to ensure all visual tasks are accomplished

Merchandising Visual Binder, Continued

Continue reading through the rest of the Visual Binder, reviewing the following sections:

- Windows
- Walls
- Floor Fixtures
- Marketing on Floor Fixtures

As you read through these sections, answer exercise #27 in your Trainee Workbook.



EXERCISE #27

Launch Packages & Updates



EXERCISE #28

Price Changes



EXERCISE #29

Building Walls



EXERCISE #30

Visual Action Plan

It's time to bring it all together! The rest of this shift will be dedicated to creating and executing a visual action plan.



EXERCISE #31



ON THE FLOOR: MOD PRACTICE – VISUAL & MERCHANDISING ACTION PLAN

Spend the rest of your shift focusing on the presentation of the store and executing tasks from your Visual Action Plan. Communicate the plan, delegate tasks as needed and ensure the team is on track to complete the plan by the end of the week.



DAILY DEBRIEF

Complete the Daily Debrief in your Trainee Workbook.

The Visual & Merchandising Shift #2 Checklist

Complete the checklist in your Trainee Workbook by checking all the topics you've covered today. If you missed any, be sure to speak with your Trainer and set a time to review. When you've covered everything, ask your Trainer to sign off at the bottom of the page.

Visual Merchandising & Marketing Standards for Managers, Continued

- ☐ Visual displays on walls, racks and T-stands

Merchandising Visual Binder

- ☐ Sections of the Binder:
 - Windows
 - Walls
 - Floor Fixtures
 - Marketing on Floor Fixtures

Launch Packages & Updates

- ☐ How to adapt a Launch Package to your store
- ☐ Adapting floor plans

Building Walls

- ☐ Creating cohesive and inspiring wall displays

Price Changes

- ☐ Executing price changes

Merchandising Action Plan

- ☐ Visual audits and walk-throughs
- ☐ Creating a Visual Action Plan that is right for your store

The Recruitment Shift (8 hours)

Activity	Suggested Time
• Complete the following on Ardene Campus: • Recruitment • Complete the training on Planning for Recruitment and Attracting for Managers • Complete the following on Ardene Campus: • Gr8 People Recruitment & Hiring System • Practice	3 hours 30 min
• Review the following on Ardene Campus: • Selection • Interview Toolkit • Complete the training on Screening, Selecting, Hiring and Onboarding for Managers • Practice	3 hours 30 min
• Daily Debrief with your Trainer	30 min

**Shift includes a 30-minute break. Confirm your schedule with your Trainer.*

After completing this module, you should be able to:

- ☐ Understand your role in recruiting and retaining talented staff for your store
- ☐ Anticipate and plan for recruitment needs
- ☐ Use our recruitment system to manage your recruitment and hiring needs
- ☐ Effectively source, screen, interview and select candidates
- ☐ Understand the relationship between recruitment and turnover, and the costs associated to it

Intro to Recruitment

Finding the right candidates is one of the most important factors of success as a manager. Recruitment has changed a lot in the last few years – between evolving communication technologies, changing population demographics and the creation of new jobs, candidates looking for work have a lot of options! That's why it's crucial for you to be proactive and really take ownership of recruitment for your store.

Best Practices:

- ☐ Recruitment is an ongoing task! Build your network and a bank of potential candidates even when there are no openings and plan recruitment tasks in your schedule regularly. We recommend devoting one hour every day to your recruitment tasks when you have open positions.
- ☐ Anticipate your recruitment needs 3 to 4 weeks ahead of time to avoid being short-staffed in key sales peaks.
- ☐ Ensure your open jobs accurately reflect your hiring needs. Take time each week to review what is posted and make changes if needed.
- ☐ Inform your team of the store's staffing needs as some employees may want additional shifts, or could even refer potential candidates.
- ☐ Keep your staff informed of your recruiting schedule as you may be away from the sales floor.
- ☐ Be a brand ambassador. While you assess potential hires throughout the recruitment process, keep in mind candidates are also assessing us, and deciding if Ardene is the right fit for them.
- ☐ Follow up with your candidates in a timely manner so you don't lose out to another competitor.



Psst! Refer to Gr8 People to review all the job descriptions.



ARDENE CAMPUS

Complete the following lesson on Ardene Campus to learn more about recruitment at Ardene.

- Recruitment



EXERCISE #32

Planning for Recruitment

It's essential to plan recruitment needs in advance to have enough time to recruit, select and onboard new hires before high sales periods. Plan for about 3 to 4 weeks ahead of time. Review the following tools with your Trainer before completing the recruitment planning exercise.



Tools to assess staffing needs

- ☐ Schedule
- ☐ Number of full-time and part-time employees currently on your team
- ☐ Target sales
- ☐ WC objectives
- ☐ Current staff availabilities and desired hours

Steps to determine your hiring needs

1. Determine the total number of hours to schedule

$$\frac{\text{Projected Wage Cost} \times \text{Target Sales}}{\text{Average Salary}} = \text{Total number of hours to schedule}$$



Psst! Remember, wage cost is a percentage!

Ex. A projected wage cost of 14% should be entered as 0.14 in the equation

2. Determine the number of hours to fill

$$\text{Hours to schedule} - \text{Hours for current management} - \text{Hours for current FT \& PT} = \text{Hours to be filled}$$



Psst! When calculating the amount of hours for current team members, use conservative numbers for the calculation of average weekly hours to anticipate absences, vacations, school exams, etc.

Ex: If a part-time employee typically works between 10-15 hours per week, use 10 hours in your calculation. This will allow you to manage requests while maintaining floor coverage.

As a general rule, the average weekly hours should be as follows:

Store Manager & Assistant Manager	37.5 hours
Key Holders	30 hours
Full-time Sales Associates	30 hours
Part-time Sales Associates	15 hours

However, these can be adjusted to reflect the reality in your store.

3. Determine the number and types of hires needed

Now that you know how many hours need to be filled, determine which types of position you need to hire to best meet the needs of your store.

For example, if you have 60 hours to fill, you could hire 4 part-time associates at an average of 15 hours per week or 2 full-time associates, depending on coverage, availabilities or roles needed in your store.



Psst! While part-time associates can give you flexibility in coverage, keep in mind that full-time associates create succession in your store for the long-term. Find the right balance for your store.

Here are the questions to ask yourself to determine the types of hires needed:

- 1) What type of positions support my store's needs? Full-time/part-time? Seasonal/permanent?
- 2) How many positions do I need?
- 3) Is there any internal potential?
- 4) Did I communicate the store's needs to my District Supervisor?

Once you have decided which positions are required and validated your needs with your District Supervisor, you can start the recruitment process and open your jobs on Gr8 People.



EXERCISES #33-34



Psst! If you need your jobs posted on websites other than our career site, reach out to your District Supervisor.

Gr8 People



ARDENE CAMPUS

Complete the following lesson on Ardene Campus to learn more about our recruitment system.

- Gr8 People Recruitment & Hiring System



EXERCISE #35

Screening & Selecting



ARDENE CAMPUS

Complete the following lessons on Ardene Campus to learn more about screening and selection:

- Selection
- Interview Toolkit

Phone Screening

The phone screen is an important part of the screening process as it represents the candidate's first interaction with Ardene. Their decision to show up for the in-person interview can be largely based on this phone call.

Best Practices:

- ☐ Set up for the phone calls in a calm and quiet space.
- ☐ Take note of key elements from each candidate's resume prior to the call.
- ☐ Introduce yourself when the person answers and explain the reason for the call.
- ☐ Share information about Ardene, like why they would want to work here and why Ardene is a good match for what they are looking for.
- ☐ Take notes of the candidate's answers to your questions.
- ☐ When ending the call, thank them for their time and explain what to expect next.
- ☐ Keep delays short; if they are retained for an interview, call them back the same day.

Questions to ask in the phone screen:

- ☐ Confirm the position the candidate is applying for.
- ☐ Confirm their current and future availabilities.
- ☐ Confirm if they are looking for full-time or part-time work, as well as how many hours per week.
- ☐ Are they available to work at other locations in the area?
- ☐ How did they hear about the open position?
- ☐ Did they apply on Gr8people? If not, explain to them how to do it and why.
- ☐ Do they know someone who works at Ardene?
- ☐ Select 2-3 additional behavioural questions from the Interview Toolkit.



EXERCISES #36-37

Hiring & Onboarding

The hiring process does not stop after extending the offer to the candidate! Make sure the candidate feels supported and knows what to expect between the moment they are hired and when they arrive in store for their first day. All these steps impact the candidate's experience and their impression of what it's like to work at Ardene.

Review the following tasks with your Trainer.

Administrative set-up for new hire:

- ☐ Complete all the appropriate steps of the offer process in Gr8 People.
- ☐ Follow up with the candidate to ensure they accept their offer and complete their onboarding documents in a timely manner.
- ☐ Work with your District Supervisor to complete a background check (if applicable).
- ☐ Verify they have an employee number in Dayforce.
- ☐ Prepare a new badge and lanyard for their first day

First Day Expectations

For the New Hire	For the Team
Give a call to your new hire prior to their first day to explain what to expect on that day. Review the following information with them: ☐ Their schedule for the first week ☐ The Ardene dress code ☐ Provide some details about training and who they will meet on their first day ☐ Explain the bag check procedure ☐ Explain the ID verification and the pieces of ID they need to bring ☐ Provide your contact information if they need to reach out	Your team should also be informed of this change in staff! ☐ Let your team know there will be a new staff member and when they are starting. Inform them of how they can support during the first few days of onboarding while you spend time with the new hire. ☐ Involve your team in ensuring the new hire has a good first impression of the team and the store. ☐ Ask for your team's help in making the new team member feel welcome and being available to help them if they have questions.

Employee Turnover

Hiring the right candidates is great, but if they don't stay, you may find yourself in a never-ending cycle of recruitment, with what is called high employee turnover.

Turnover is the number of employees who leave a company in a given time period as a percentage of total employees (headcount).

$$\text{Turnover} = \frac{\text{Number of employees leaving}}{\text{Headcount}} \times 100$$

Types of turnover:	Voluntary	Involuntary
Definition:	Termination initiated by the employee	Termination initiated by the employer
Examples:	Resignation, retirement, job abandonment	Dismissal, store closure

While some turnover is normal, too much voluntary turnover can be a symptom of issues at work. Turnover can be very costly if not managed properly, as turnover generates more turnover. As a manager, you can have a big impact on turnover by hiring the right candidates, making sure your team stays engaged and addressing issues as they arise.



EXERCISE #38



ON THE FLOOR: MOD PRACTICE – RECRUITMENT

Now spend the next few hours as MOD and help your Trainer with any recruitment tasks that need to be completed. For example, practice approaching potential candidates in stores, welcoming walk-in candidates, promoting the Employee Referral Program to store associates or ensuring appropriate recruitment signage is posted in store.



DAILY DEBRIEF

Complete the Daily Debrief in your Trainee Workbook.

Recruitment Shift Checklist

Complete the checklist in your Trainee Workbook by checking all the topics you've covered today. If you missed any, be sure to speak with your Trainer and set a time to review. When you've covered everything, ask your Trainer to sign off at the bottom of the page.

Introduction to Recruitment

- ☐ Your role in attracting, selecting and retaining great talent
- ☐ Recruitment lesson on Ardene Campus

Planning for Recruitment

- ☐ Importance of planning for recruitment
- ☐ How to determine staffing needs

Gr8 People

- ☐ Gr8 People Recruitment & Hiring System lesson on Ardene Campus

Screening & Selecting

- ☐ Phone screening best practices
- ☐ What to look for in candidates
- ☐ How to use the Interview Toolkit
- ☐ Interviewing using behavioural questions
- ☐ Lessons on Ardene Campus:
 - Selection
 - Interview Toolkit

Hiring & Onboarding

- ☐ How onboarding impacts the candidate experience
- ☐ Administrative set-up for new hires

Turnover

- ☐ Understanding turnover
- ☐ How recruitment impacts turnover
- ☐ How you can impact turnover as a manager

The Leadership Shift (8 hours)

Activity	Suggested Time
- Ardene Campus lessons: - Motivating your Team - S.T.A.R. Program - Coaching & Feedback - Conflict Resolution - Change Moves Us Forward - Mindful Moments	2 hours
Complete the Leadership exercises	1 hour
- Ardene Campus lessons: - Building Healthier Workplaces for All - Performance Management - Complete the training on employee performance	2 hours
Practice	2 hours
Daily Debrief with your Trainer	30 min

**Shift includes a 30-minute break. Confirm your schedule with your Trainer.*

After completing this module, you should be able to:

- ☐ Motivate your team to succeed
- ☐ Recognize achievements and make positive reinforcement a habit
- ☐ Give constructive feedback and understand the impact of continuous coaching
- ☐ Prevent and resolve conflict among the team
- ☐ Confidently manage change with a positive attitude
- ☐ Create a positive, uplifting and supportive work environment
- ☐ Describe the importance of supporting mental health in the workplace and use supportive coaching language with your team
- ☐ Address employee performance using the tools available
- ☐ Help your team manage daily challenges and improve their well-being through mindfulness

Motivation



ARDENE CAMPUS

Complete the following on Ardene Campus:

- Motivating your Team
- S.T.A.R. Program
- Coaching & Feedback



EXERCISE # 39

Conflict Resolution

As a leader, it's important that you understand how to respond to conflict appropriately and be mindful of how you can prevent it from re-occurring. Understanding how to effectively manage conflict when it occurs will inspire confidence and ensure a positive experience for your team and your customers.

ARDENE CAMPUS

Complete the following on Ardene Campus:

- Conflict Resolution

EXERCISE #40

Change Management and Mindfulness

ARDENE CAMPUS

Complete the following on Ardene Campus:

- Change Moves Us Forward
- Mindful Moments

EXERCISE # 41

Mental Health at Work

As a leader, it's important to recognize your team members could be dealing with something in their personal life, which you may not see or know about, that affects them at work. Mental health issues are more widespread than we tend to think, and that's why it's crucial to talk about mental health: to better understand it, reduce the stigma around it and be better equipped to respond to our friends and colleagues who may need support.

While your role as a manager is not to diagnose or advise on mental health matters, you can have a tremendous impact on your team's wellbeing by taking care of your own mental health, using supportive coaching language and fostering a healthy work environment in your store.

ARDENE CAMPUS

Complete the following on Ardene Campus:

- Building Healthier Workplaces for All

EXERCISE #42

Employee Performance

Coaching your team on behaviours and performance is a key responsibility of any manager role, as it ensures everyone is working together towards our common goals. Addressing issues as they arise will not only contribute to a good work environment, but also help us reach our business objectives. Employee coaching should be a continuous and constructive process.

Always remember to reflect our values, competencies and leadership abilities in your coaching conversations!



Tools to help manage expectations and address performance:

- ☐ Ardene Code of Conduct
- ☐ Job description
- ☐ Backstore Board documents
- ☐ Course "Policies & Guidelines" on Ardene Campus
- ☐ We Are Ardene
- ☐ FISE model
- ☐ PIP & BOP guidelines



ARDENE CAMPUS

Complete the following on Ardene Campus:

- Performance Management



EXERCISE #43



ON THE FLOOR: MOD PRACTICE

Now that you have a good understanding of the leadership qualities that we expect you to exhibit, act as MOD for the rest of your shift and find opportunities to practice what you have learned. Get to know the team, motivate them to accomplish today's goals, say THANK YOU and encourage them to take a Mindful Moment if they seem overwhelmed. Remember, stay positive and be enthusiastic, your energy will help create a great working environment and inspire your team to do their best!



DAILY DEBRIEF

Complete the Daily Debrief in your Trainee Workbook.

The Leadership Shift Checklist

Complete the checklist in your Trainee Workbook by checking all the topics you've covered today. If you missed any, be sure to speak with your Trainer and set a time to review. When you've covered everything, ask your Trainer to sign off at the bottom of the page.

Motivation

- ☐ Motivating your staff to achieve results
- ☐ Setting SMART goals
- ☐ Recognition Cards
- ☐ S.T.A.R. Program guidelines
- ☐ Impact of coaching and constructive feedback on store presentation
- ☐ Impact of coaching and constructive feedback on sales and customer service
- ☐ Creating a positive work environment that fosters collaboration
- ☐ Lessons on Ardene Campus:
 - Motivating your Team
 - S.T.A.R. Program
 - Coaching & Feedback

Conflict Resolution

- ☐ How to manage and resolve conflict on your team
- ☐ Conflict Resolution lesson on Ardene Campus

Change Management and Mindfulness

- ☐ Lessons on Ardene Campus:
 - Changes Moves Us Forward
 - Mindful Moments
- ☐ Mindful Moments Cards

Mental Health at Work

- ☐ Role as a leader in promoting mental health
- ☐ FISE model
- ☐ Lesson Building Healthier Workplaces for All on Ardene Campus

Employee Performance

- ☐ Tools available to manage performance
- ☐ Performance management process
- ☐ How to write a PIP and a BOP
- ☐ Performance Management lesson on Ardene Campus

The Admin Day Shift (8 hours)

Activity	Suggested Time
• Complete the Weekly Store Assessment • Complete the recovery • Complete the payroll admin	3 hours
• Build a plan for the week ahead • Execute your daily action plan	4 hours
• Daily Debrief with your Trainer	30 min

**Shift includes a 30-minute break. Confirm your schedule with your Trainer.*

After completing this module, you should be able to:

- ☐ Understand the importance of an admin day to recover the store and prepare for the week ahead
- ☐ Use the Weekly Store Assessment to help identify and prioritize tasks
- ☐ Complete all the tasks necessary to recover the store from the weekend
- ☐ Anticipate and plan for upcoming tasks
- ☐ Organize your week and coordinate your team effectively to achieve goals and ensure the store runs smoothly

The Admin Day

Business operations in store can move very quickly and get overwhelming fast. Making Monday your “Admin Day” gives you the chance to reset the store from high-traffic weekends, plan for the days ahead and organize your team so everyone knows what to do. An Admin Day is comprised of 4 parts:

1. Weekly Store Assessment
2. Recovery from the weekend
3. Payroll admin
4. Building a plan for the week ahead



EXERCISE #44

Weekly Store Assessment

The Weekly Store Assessment (WSA) is a tool to help ensure the store is up to standards and assess what needs to be done. The WSA is completed every Monday to determine priorities for the day and the week, as well as every Friday to follow up and ensure each task has been completed.

You will use the WSA throughout the day to help determine priorities for both recovery and planning for the week ahead.

Recovery

After higher weekend traffic, your store may need a quick refresh to be customer-ready for the week. The “First Impression” section of the WSA helps you identify and prioritize the tasks to recover the store from the weekend so you can start the week on the right foot. The recovery tasks identified in this section should be done quickly and promptly.



ON THE FLOOR: “FIRST IMPRESSION”

Complete the “First Impression” section of the WSA, taking notes as you go along in your Planner. Then, using your notes, assist your Trainer in completing the recovery from the weekend, delegating as needed.

Payroll Admin

In addition to the recovery tasks identified above, your Admin Day is the perfect time to complete your payroll tasks:

1. Approving payroll

Confirm with your Trainer when payroll must be approved in your region. If applicable, assist your Trainer in correcting and approving timesheets from the previous week.

2. Creating the schedule

Plan time in your Admin Day to build the upcoming schedule. As a reminder, the schedule should be available at least 2 weeks in advance.



Psst! Although you have already created the upcoming schedule in the Opening Shift, your Admin Day is normally the best day to do this task.

Planning for the Week Ahead

Before completing exercise #45 and creating this week’s plan, review the following best practices with your Trainer.

Best Practices:

- ☐ Consider the schedule, total number of employees on the salesfloor and peak sales periods. You may need to adjust the schedule based on anticipated workload and/or sales. Be mindful of provincial or state legislation if shifts need to be modified.
- ☐ Think of how each task helps us achieve our Corporate Objectives.
- ☐ Leverage your team members’ strengths when delegating.
- ☐ Be strategic in how you plan your days. Instead of considering each task individually, be aware of the store operations as a whole and how tasks impact each other.
- ☐ Keep your plan flexible and reprioritize throughout the week as needed.
- ☐ Ensure all tasks are executed by Friday, when you will complete the WSA again.



EXERCISE #45



ON THE FLOOR: MOD PRACTICE

Spend the rest of your shift as MOD, practicing what you have learned so far and completing your action plan.



DAILY DEBRIEF

Complete the Daily Debrief in your Trainee Workbook.

Admin Day Shift Checklist

Complete the checklist in your Trainee Workbook by checking all the topics you've covered today. If you missed any, be sure to speak with your Trainer and set a time to review. When you've covered everything, ask your Trainer to sign off at the bottom of the page.

The Admin Day

- ☐ Importance of scheduling an admin day during the week

Weekly Store Assessment

- ☐ Purpose of the Weekly Store Assessment
- ☐ Completing the Weekly Store Assessment

Recovery

- ☐ Recovering the store from the weekend

Payroll Admin

- ☐ When to plan payroll admin tasks in your week

Building Your Weekly Plan

- ☐ Using the Weekly Store Assessment to identify tasks to be completed
- ☐ Anticipate upcoming tasks
- ☐ Building a realistic and efficient plan for your team for the week ahead

The Performance Shift (8 hours)

Activity	Suggested Time
- Review the Omnichannel journeys at Ardene - Assist in completing the relevant Omni tasks for your store	2 hours
Practice capturing customer loyalty	30 min
- Review the tools available to drive store performance - Review KPI's and how to influence them	2 hours
- Review how to set and achieve performance objectives that are in line with our Corporate Objectives - Practice	2 hours 30 min
Daily Debrief with your Trainer	30 min

**Shift includes a 30-minute break. Confirm your schedule with your Trainer.*

After completing this module, you should be able to:

- ☐ Understand the Omnichannel journey at Ardene
- ☐ Understand your role and the tools at your disposal to drive performance
- ☐ Explain the different KPI's used to measure performance and how to influence them
- ☐ Create impactful and motivating store objectives in line with our Corporate Objectives
- ☐ Use the SMART model for objective-setting

Omnichannel

Now more than ever, it's so important to stay connected with our customers. Omnichannel provides a fully integrated shopping experience by uniting customer experiences; from brick-and-mortar to mobile browsing and everything in between.

Omnichannel is in constant evolution, and there are different journeys available in different stores. Make sure to stay updated on changes to procedures.

Omnichannel Journeys:

Review the overall purpose of the following omnichannel journeys with your Trainer.

- ☐ Ship from store
- ☐ Save the sale
- ☐ Pick up in store



EXERCISE #46

Next, complete the following for each journey that applies to the location where you'll be working:

1. Review the available training documents.
2. Go over each task step by step with your Trainer.
3. Assist in completing tasks and fulfilling orders.

In the case that not all journeys need to be reviewed, add additional time to On the Floor – MOD Practice.

Customer Loyalty

Customer loyalty helps us build long-term relationships with our customers. Loyal customers make repeated purchases and are more likely to refer other shoppers to our brand. One way for us to increase customer loyalty is by gathering customer information. This allows us to communicate with our customers on a regular basis (through newsletters for example) to let them know of our new product drops, promotions, and events. It also helps us keep track of their shopping habits, characteristics and preferences, so we can in turn offer a customized shopping experience and increase the likelihood that they will return.

Refer to available training materials for more information.



EXERCISE #47

Afterwards, review the best practices below with your Trainer.

Best Practices:

- ☐ As a priority, suggest that the customer download our app for a seamless in-store loyalty experience (if they don't already have it!)
 - Use your interactions with customers on the sales floor to promote the app before they get to the cash.
 - Alternatively, ask for the customer's email during the transaction.
- ☐ Confirm the spelling of any information collected from the customer (ex. email address) to ensure it's correct.
- ☐ Be creative! Try different ways to approach customers, adapting to your audience each time.
- ☐ Demonstrate the value of what you're suggesting to the customer and what's in it for them.
- ☐ Stay polite; try to overcome a customer's objections, but don't impose.
- ☐ If applicable, keep targets in mind and use the reports available to ensure they are met.
- ☐ Practice builds confidence! The more you ask, the more comfortable you will be.



EXERCISE #48

Driving Store Performance

Review the following tools with your Trainer and make sure you understand and how to use each one.



Tools to Drive Store Performance

- ☐ Weekly Store Assessment
- ☐ Planner
- ☐ KPI's
- ☐ Customer Service Model
- ☐ SMART goal-setting model

KPI's

Recall the KPI's introduced to you in the Closing Shift and the formulas to calculate them. As a manager, you not only track KPI's to measure daily store performance, but you also directly influence them by setting priorities and targets for your team.

As you become more comfortable with KPI's and achieving them, you'll continue to develop strategies to push past and exceed the targets set for you.

Before completing exercise #49, take a moment to think of the different factors that affect KPI's:

- Customer service
- Store readiness
- Inventory levels
- Schedule and staffing
- Merchandising and visual presentations
- In-store marketing and promotions
- Staff's understanding and involvement
- Overall team synergy and engagement
- Anything that affects mall traffic (weather, construction, events...)



EXERCISE #49

One of the most important steps in achieving sales results is being aware of past, current and upcoming targets. It's never a good feeling when you miss your target by a couple of dollars and only realize it once it's too late. Forecasting and tracking sales results should be done daily to ensure everyone is aware of goals and progress. Additionally, when you do achieve your targets, take the opportunity to recognize what strategies allowed you to get there and what else you can do to push beyond!

Take some time with your Trainer to review this week's budget forecast and complete exercise #50.



EXERCISE #50

Objectives

While it's important to set targets for your own store, they should be aligned with our larger Corporate Objectives, which you were introduced to earlier in your training, to ensure we are all working together towards common goals.



EXERCISE #51



ON THE FLOOR: MOD PRACTICE - KPI'S

Spend the next few hours on the floor as the MOD. Practice using the tools at your disposal to influence results, and involve your employees in achieving your KPI targets and the identified store objective from the previous exercise.



DAILY DEBRIEF

Complete the Daily Debrief in your Trainee Workbook.

Performance Shift Checklist

Complete the checklist in your Trainee Workbook by checking all the topics you've covered today. If you missed any, be sure to speak with your Trainer and set a time to review. When you've covered everything, ask your Trainer to sign off at the bottom of the page.

Omnichannel

- ☐ Importance of Omnichannel
- ☐ Omnichannel journeys at Ardene

Customer Loyalty

- ☐ Advantages of customer loyalty for the business, your store and our customers
- ☐ Best practices to approach customers

Tools to drive Store Performance

- ☐ Review of tools available

KPI's

- ☐ Factors that impact KPI's
- ☐ Importance of communicating objectives and targets to the team
- ☐ Involving the team in achieving KPI's
- ☐ Pushing past targets

Objectives

- ☐ Creating individual store goals in line with our Corporate Objectives
- ☐ Using the SMART model to create objectives

The Recap Shift (8 hours)

Activity	Suggested Time
• Review of Policies, Guidelines & Programs	1 hour
• Optional store-specific practice	1 hour 30 min
• Complete remainder of Ardene Campus lessons	2 hours
• Self-Assessment	30 min
• Practice or MOD	2 hours
• Daily Debrief with your Trainer	30 min

**Shift includes a 30-minute break. Confirm your schedule with your Trainer.*

After completing this module, you should be able to:

- ☐ Feel comfortable with everything you have learned so far about being a leader
- ☐ Understand and be comfortable with tasks that are specific to your store location

Review of Policies, Guidelines & Programs

Congratulations, you have made it to the final day of your training! Take an hour to review all the material found in the Policies & Guidelines course on Ardene Campus and the Backstore Boards. Is there anything that you would like to review with your Trainer? Now is the time to ask any questions you still have.

Store-Specific Practice

Using the space provided in your Trainee Workbook, make a plan with your Trainer to review the areas or tasks that are particular to the location where you'll be working.

ARDENE CAMPUS

Log in to Ardene Campus and complete any outstanding lesson on your dashboard.

New lessons are added to Ardene Campus all the time! This is your opportunity to catch up on any lesson that wasn't listed in this training or that you didn't have time to complete earlier.

Self-Assessment

Now that you've had time to reflect on your entire training, complete the self-assessment in your Trainee Workbook as a final review. For each of the topics, rate your level of understanding and mastery using the scale provided.

We don't expect you to become an expert manager overnight! This self-assessment is not an evaluation, but more a tool to help you identify areas where you may need to spend more time or practice over the first few months in your new role. Use it to take ownership of your development and success as a new manager.

Important! Keep this self-assessment handy for when you next meet with your leader.



EXERCISE #52



ON THE FLOOR: MOD OR PRACTICE

Spend the rest of your shift as MOD practicing what you have learned so far or reviewing areas where you feel you need more practice.



DAILY DEBRIEF

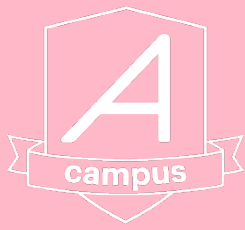
Complete the Daily Debrief in the Trainee Workbook.

The Recap Shift Checklist

Complete the checklist in your Trainee Workbook by checking all the topics you've covered today. If you missed any, be sure to speak with your Trainer and set a time to review. When you've covered everything, ask your Trainer to sign off at the bottom of the page.

Review

- ☐ Review of training material
- ☐ Review of policies and programs
- ☐ Review particularities specific to your location
- ☐ All lessons on Ardene Campus have been completed



Completion

CONGRATULATIONS!

You have completed the Ardene Management Training and are now ready to manage your own team. Speak to your leader to learn more about your next shifts.

Stay Up to Date

Don't forget to stay current on new or changing merchandise, collections, programs, policies and procedures by logging on to Ardene Campus regularly and viewing new lessons. The following courses most frequently have new material and important information for management:

- Manage in Style
- Stay in the Know
- Policies & Guidelines

30-60-90

We want to make sure you have the right tools and resources to feel comfortable in your new role. You will have scheduled check-ins with your leader throughout your 3-month probation period, at the 30-, 60-, and 90-day marks, to make sure you are on track for success and to provide additional support where needed.

- **30-Day Follow-up:** The first 30 days is all about getting to know the company and understanding roles and responsibilities.
- **60-Day Follow-up:** The second month follow-up is about taking on more responsibility and implementing the skills and knowledge acquired from the first month of training.
- **90-Day Follow-up:** This follow-up is all about gaining independence and taking accountability.

Speak to your leader to plan each of the follow-ups and write the approximate date in the corresponding space in your Trainee Workbook.

Remember to bring your self-assessment from Exercise #52 to these meetings to review it with your leader!

We are here to support your professional development and growth. Take ownership of your training and speak to your leader about development needs and opportunities. Wishing you a long and successful career at Ardene!

